



DoView Tool E13 - When Community Action Should Be Used Versus Community Development Checklist

Community Action is an initiative where providers are contracted to work on a specified outcome area. Community Development is a broader approach where the community decides on the outcome areas and strategies to use. Both strategies can be undertaken within a community at the same time. A DoView strategy/outcomes diagram can help clarify the distinction when contracting for such programs.

Community Action

The initiative focuses on a specific topic and specific outcomes.

Activity needs to fit within the ambit of what the outcomes being funded by the funder

The funder may require that the activity undertaken is evidence-based

Community Development

Outcomes can be any outcomes determined by the community.

Activity can be any activity that the community believes will improve outcomes

The community will decide the type of strategy it will use and may, if it wishes, put a priority on strategies being evidence-based

Checklist

1. Is government or other funding only available to work on a particular outcome area? IF YES, USE COMMUNITY ACTION.
2. Is the community seeking to define its own outcomes and strategies to get to them? IF YES, USE COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT.
3. Is there a provider/institution with credibility in the community which could provide a base where the initiative could be located? WORKS WITH EITHER APPROACH.
4. Can government or other funding be found to focus specifically on one outcome area that is considered important by the community? IF YES, USE COMMUNITY ACTION TO COMPLEMENT A COMMUNITY DEVELOPMENT INITIATIVE.